JAMES MITCHELL

Principal Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with a decade of hands-on experience building and scaling backend systems that handle millions of transactions daily. I started as a junior developer and worked my way up through progressive technical leadership roles, focusing on cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, and team mentorship. My approach combines pragmatic engineering with a focus on solving real business problems rather than chasing the latest trends. I've led teams through major infrastructure migrations and helped establish engineering practices that stuck.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Vertex Systems Ltd

https://www.vertexsystems.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Promoted to lead technical strategy across the platform engineering division overseeing a team of eight senior engineers and architects across distributed systems and infrastructure. Designed and implemented a comprehensive service mesh migration that reduced latency by 35% and improved observability across 40+ microservices handling 500K requests per second. Established the engineering roadmap process and technical standards that improved code review cycle times from four days to one day average. Mentored three engineers into senior roles through structured technical progression and regular one-on-ones focused on career development.

Senior Software Engineer

Cascade Digital

https://www.cascadedigital.co

London, United Kingdom

June 2018 - February 2022

Led the design and delivery of a complete rewrite of the core data processing pipeline using Kafka and Apache Spark, which increased throughput capacity by 400% and reduced processing time from hours to minutes. Responsible for hiring and onboarding five engineers into the platform team and establishing code standards and testing practices that reduced production incidents by 60%. Built and maintained Terraform infrastructure as code for a multi-region AWS deployment serving six million users across Europe. Took on-call responsibilities for critical systems and implemented automated incident response procedures that reduced mean time to resolution from two hours to fifteen minutes.

Software Engineer

TechHub Solutions Ltd

https://www.techhubsolutions.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

August 2014 - May 2018

Developed and maintained backend services in Python and Go handling high-volume transactional workloads with uptime requirements of 99.99%. Contributed to the migration of a monolithic application to microservices architecture by designing and implementing three independent services that reduced deployment time from thirty minutes to three minutes. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting using Prometheus and Grafana which provided visibility into system behaviour and reduced time spent debugging production issues. Partnered with the database team to optimize slow queries and implement connection pooling strategies that improved application response times by 45%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Graduated June 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD pipelines

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Elasticsearch

Messaging and Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Protocols and Tools: REST APIs, gRPC, Git, Linux system administration

Architectural Patterns: Microservices, Event-driven systems, CQRS, Domain-driven design